

"Jolla offers something new and fresh, and a lot of people love it!"

If you are someone who likes trying out something new, check out the Jolla smartphone. This different, rather unconventional device has just been made available in India. The smartphone comes as a breath of fresh air from the makers of Meego and is based on open source technology. The best part is that the makers are not snooping on your data. **Diksha P Gupta** from *Open Source For You* caught up with **Marc Dillon, co-founder and chief operating officer, Jolla**, to discover more about what the new smartphone and operating system are all about, and to find out how Jolla differs from Android. Read on...



Marc Dillon, co-founder and chief operating officer, Jolla

Q I understand that the Jolla team took a long time to develop this ecosystem after Meego had finished with it...do correct me if I'm wrong.

We built the Jolla smartphone in six months because we were partners with ST Ericsson and we were ready to go into final production. But Ericsson changed its business so we had to start from scratch. We have been working on the operating system, but we essentially created this product in six months.

Q How much of Jolla is Meego?

We took some of the lower layers, and most importantly, the people, the passion and the thoughts about where to go forward. The Meego operating system that was left in the open source world had about a billion dollars' worth of investments. We took parts of it forward to create something that was new, with a new user interface, integration with QT—which is the framework for anyone to make a Sailfish (Jolla's OS) application, et al.

Q So is this your first launch for Jolla mobile phones?

In India, it is the first. We first launched in Finland last year, and then we went to places like Hong Kong and Kazakhstan. There are a couple of more launches coming up.

Q What has the response and uptake for Sailfish been like, vis-a-vis the other open source platforms like Android, Firefox OS and Android One?

First of all, Android isn't open any more. Google is closing things down, and it is getting increasingly more closed. There are a lot of restrictions on what you can do with Google's code. The company has a lot of licensing terms and things like that.

Firefox's mobile OS is a kind of low-end thing, with no standard for HTML5, which is the basis of the UI. Firefox is targeting the lower end of the market, as opposed to what we are trying to do. I think that we have a high-end user experience at a reasonable price. The hardware is more than good enough to be able to have all your applications open all the time.

Google may market its phones in different ways, but basically, all its phones are the same. If manufacturers want to create something new, they either push the price point down (which makes it difficult for them to make money) or they make luxury, high-end phones. Since there is nothing much that they can do to the software, manufacturers have to do something to the hardware to make it different, which is quite a challenge. However, we are different inside out. So, allowing the users to multitask, without selling their data; giving them the capability to use the phone comfortably with one hand; and other such features are the USPs of a Jolla smartphone. These unique features make a Jolla smartphone a very compelling device.

Q That is great, but India is the kind of market that likes tried and tested stuff instead of experimenting with something new, unless it's from a huge brand. Sailfish is a pretty new player in the software ecosystem and you have not partnered with any brand on the hardware front either. Why?

'Ecosystem' is a funny word! The term was created around marketing ideas like how many apps there are in a store, but one has to understand that there are only a few that are important to everyone, and then there are a few that are important to a specific set of people. A person doesn't need 800,000 applications. So, the first thing we had looked at was our Android compatibility. There is zero Android in